# Graduate school

For Queens College students in political science or any major thinking about a PhD or a policy master's. Most of the programs in the full guide are free, and many pay you.

## Degrees and paths

### PhD

Research and teaching. Funded with tuition and a stipend; 5–6 years.

### Predoc

A paid research job for 1–2 years before a PhD, open to any major. Apply in the fall of senior year.

### MPP

Design and evaluate policy. About 2 years. Baruch's Marxe School is adding one (first class fall 2027).

### MPA

Run public and nonprofit organizations. 1–2 years; CUNY programs cost far less than private ones.

### MA

Graduate study and methods without a PhD. 1–2 years.

# Year by year

## Freshman

**Explore and protect your GPA**

- Take PSCI 100-level courses and PSCI 200.
- Go to one professor's office hours.
- Protect your GPA; many programs cut off at 3.0.
- Summer: a paid job or internship.

## Sophomore

**Get research experience**

- Take an intro statistics course (PSYCH 107 or DATA 205).
- Ask professors about research assistant work.
- Apply for summer research: MIT MSRP, Leadership Alliance, Big Ten SROP, Yale SURF.
- Apply to Honors in the Social Sciences.

## Junior

**Apply to summer research**

**Busiest year**

- Apply to RBSI, PPIA, MIT MSRP and the Truman Scholarship (November–February).
- Albany session internships (campus dates in October).
- The CUNY Pipeline Program (early March).
- Apply to fall PhD visit programs in July–August.

## Senior

**Apply, or work first**

- Take the GRE by October if your programs want it; ask for letters early.
- The APSA Diversity Fellowship (late October).
- PhD applications close late November to mid-December; apply to policy master's too.
- Or work first: Coro, Urban Fellows, Civil Service Pathways, predocs.

# When things usually close

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| **Sept–Oct** | Economics predoc jobs, the APSA Diversity Fellowship and QC's fall scholarship application |
| **November** | PPIA summer institutes and the Albany session internships |
| **December** | Most PhD applications |

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| **Jan–Feb** | Summer research (RBSI, MIT MSRP, Leadership Alliance, Big Ten SROP, Yale SURF), the Truman Scholarship and Coro |
| **March** | The CUNY Pipeline Program and QC's spring scholarship application |
| **July–Aug** | Fall PhD visit programs, for rising seniors |

# Help on campus

**Office of Honors and Scholarships**
Rebecca Baron, Advisor for Scholarships and Fellowships, helps with statements of purpose, Truman and other fellowships.

**Your professors**
Office hours, research assistant work and, later, letters of recommendation.

**Center for Career Engagement and Internships**
Frese Hall 213. Résumé reviews, mock interviews and the stipend for unpaid internships.

**Office of Undergraduate Research**
The spring research symposium. OUGR@qc.cuny.edu.

## Every program and deadline

Exact dates, updated every week, at maljahmi.github.io/qc-polisci-pathways

Student-made guide by Mohamed Aljahmi, not an official Queens College or CUNY publication. Dates change every year; confirm each one on the official page before you apply. Questions: mohamed.aljahmi@qc.cuny.edu.